Apps can express your ideas

Choose any school-appropriate topic. Learn how an interface connects a user action to a response.

Inform

Share knowledge, facts or a guide.

Showcase

Present products, artwork or a collection.

Entertain

Create a quiz, story or small game.

Express

Share an interest, opinion or creative idea.

These are possibilities. You can choose another appropriate purpose.

Interface	What the user sees and operates.
User event	A user action, such as selecting an item, that can trigger instructions.
App response	What the app shows, plays or changes after the action.

Today: design your first screen and two interactions. Build your app in the practical lesson.

Investigate how an app responds

Study one app you already know. Notice the relationship between a user action and the app response.

1. Choose an app you can already open or view. Spend no more than one minute choosing.
2. Find two actions a user can take. For each action, notice what appears, changes or plays.
3. Copy and complete the two-row table below. Name controls and responses precisely.

If you cannot open an app

Use two of these provided examples and label your work "provided example".

Music: press Play; audio starts.
Product gallery: select an item; its details appear.
Interactive story: choose a path; the next scene appears.

User action (event)	App response (output / change)

Check: name the visible change or sound. Avoid writing only "it works".

Choose your own app

Keep your idea personal to your interests. Focus today on one part that a user could try.

Make three decisions

What is your app about?

Who would use it?

What should that person be able to do?

A big idea is welcome. Choose one feature to design first.

My app is about...

It is for...

The first feature lets the user...

Success today

Someone can identify your audience, purpose and first useful interaction.

Sketch your first screen

Choose your content and controls. Draw a first screen that suits your own app.

1. Add a meaningful title and the content your user needs.
2. Show controls for two actions. These could be buttons, images, menu choices or an input.
3. Label the controls. Use arrows or notes to show what opens, changes or plays.

A control is something a user operates, such as a button or menu. You choose the layout.

DRAW YOUR OWN FIRST SCREEN

Describe two interactions

Show exactly how your app responds to two user actions.

Choose two actions from your sketch. Write each action and its exact response. If a new page opens, name it. If a sound plays, identify it.

EXAMPLES FROM DIFFERENT APP TYPES

User action	App response
Product app: select a trainer image	Show that trainer's size options and details.
Story app: choose "Explore the cave"	Display the cave scene and its next choices.

YOUR APP - WRITE YOUR OWN TWO INTERACTIONS

When the user...	My app responds by...

Walk through and improve your design

Use your sketch and response table together. You can complete this check independently.

1. Point to the first control. Read its label, then follow the response you wrote. Does the next step make sense?

2. Repeat for the second action. Check that your sketch shows where the response or next choice belongs.

3. Improve one unclear label, missing detail or awkward layout. Record the change with a short note or arrow.

Keep these together

Your audience and purpose.

Your labelled first-screen sketch.

Your two interaction descriptions.

One marked improvement.

Save for the next lesson

Keep the paper, or save a clear photo/digital copy with your app title.